



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

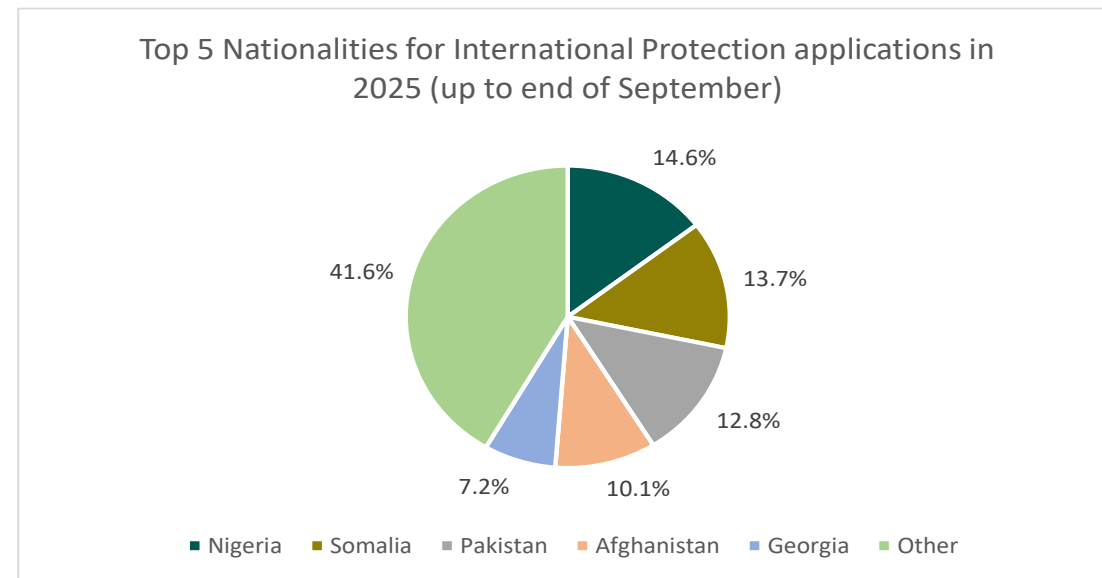
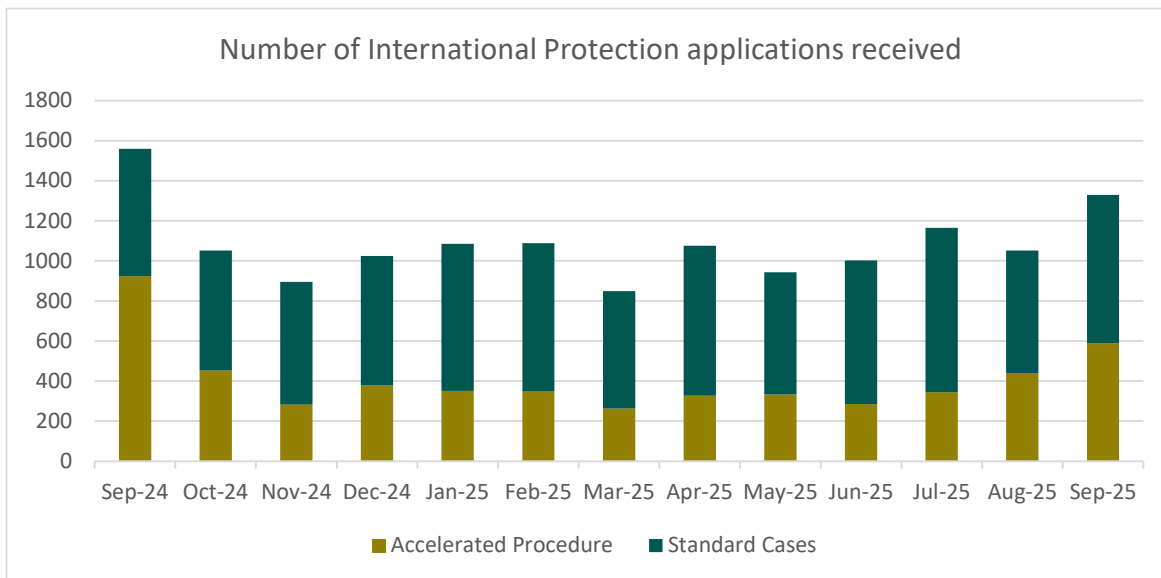
International Protection: September 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 02nd October 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for September 2025:

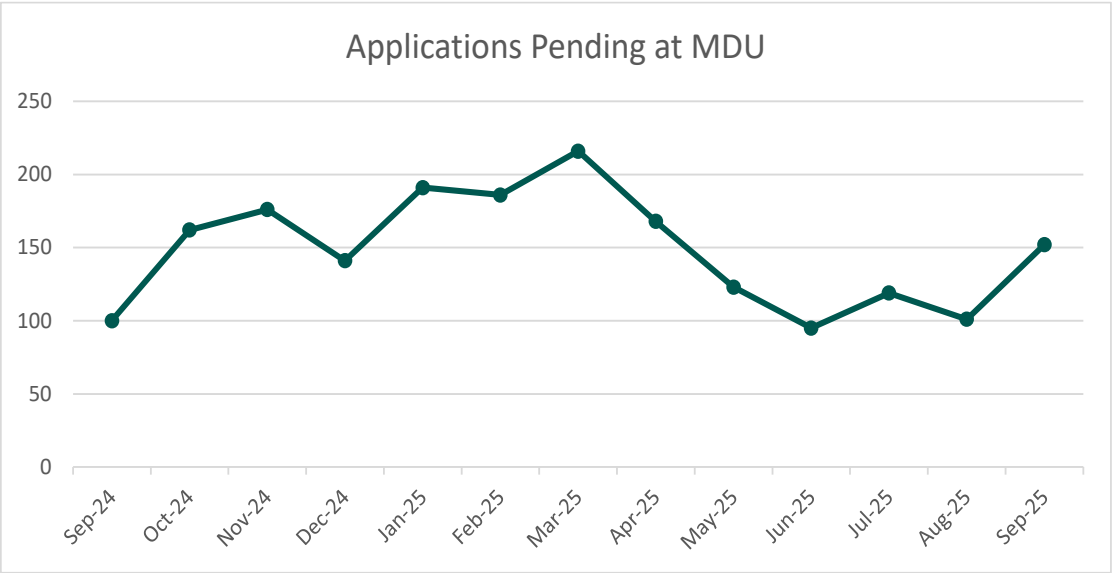
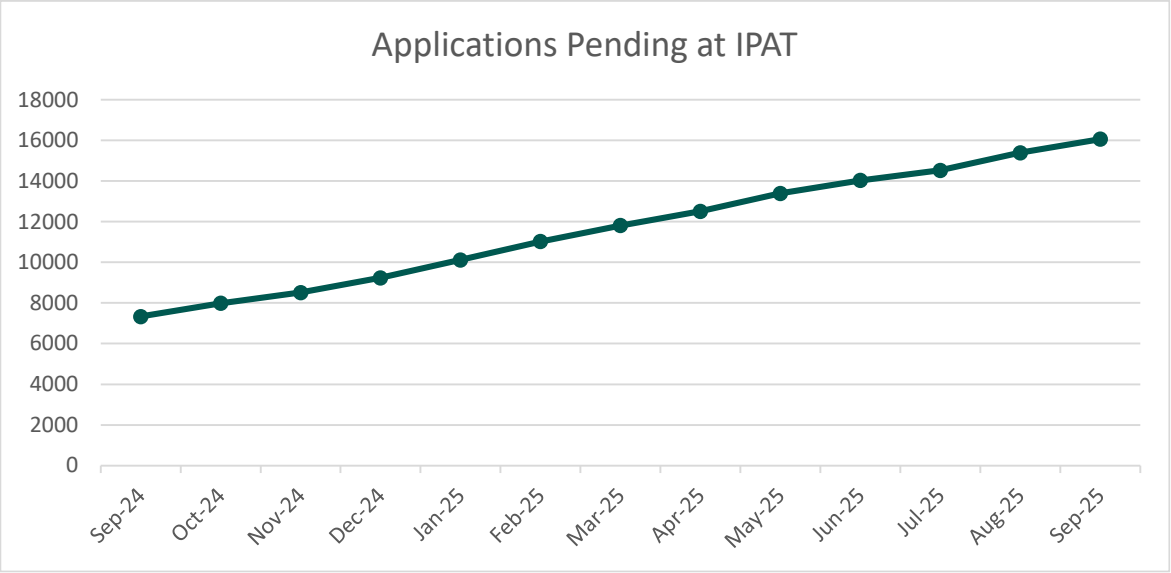
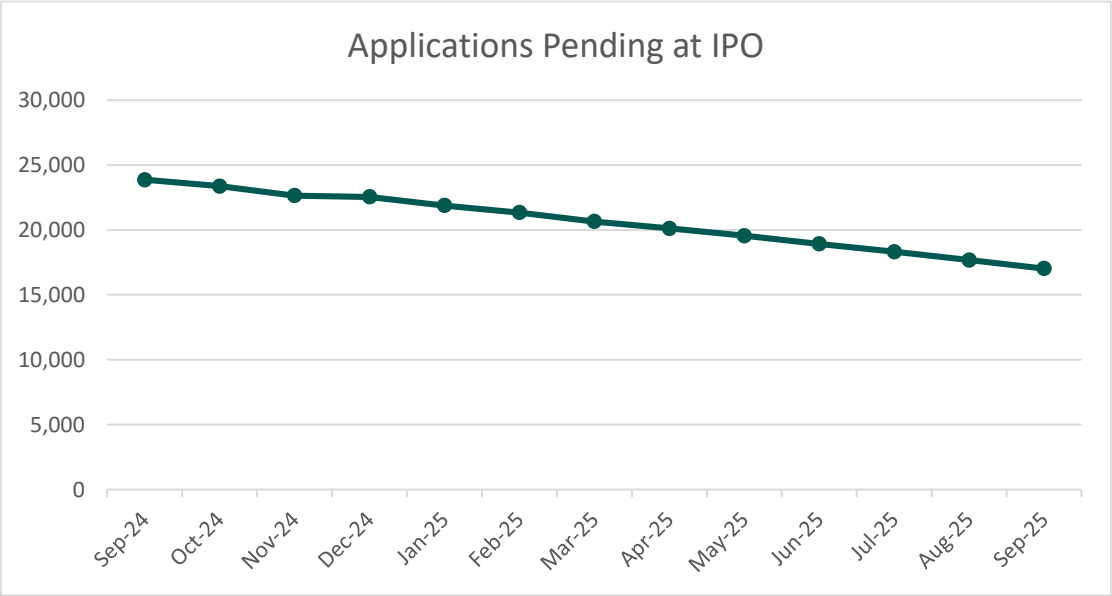
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has dropped significantly. In September 2025 there were 1,330 applications compared to 1,559 in September 2024. So far this year, through September, the total number of applications has dropped from 15,583 down to 9,589, a reduction of 38.5%
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (1,401 applications), Somalia (1,315), Pakistan (1,230), Afghanistan (967) and Georgia (690)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of September this year, there were 17,021 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been an increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In September 2025, 1,936 cases were closed off compared to 1,364 in September 2024
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has been trending slightly upwards in the last two months. In September 2025, the median processing time to determination was 75 weeks (compared to 71 weeks in March 2025 and 71 weeks in June 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO has increased slightly, to 618 at the end of September 2025
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in September 2025 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 54% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 44% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



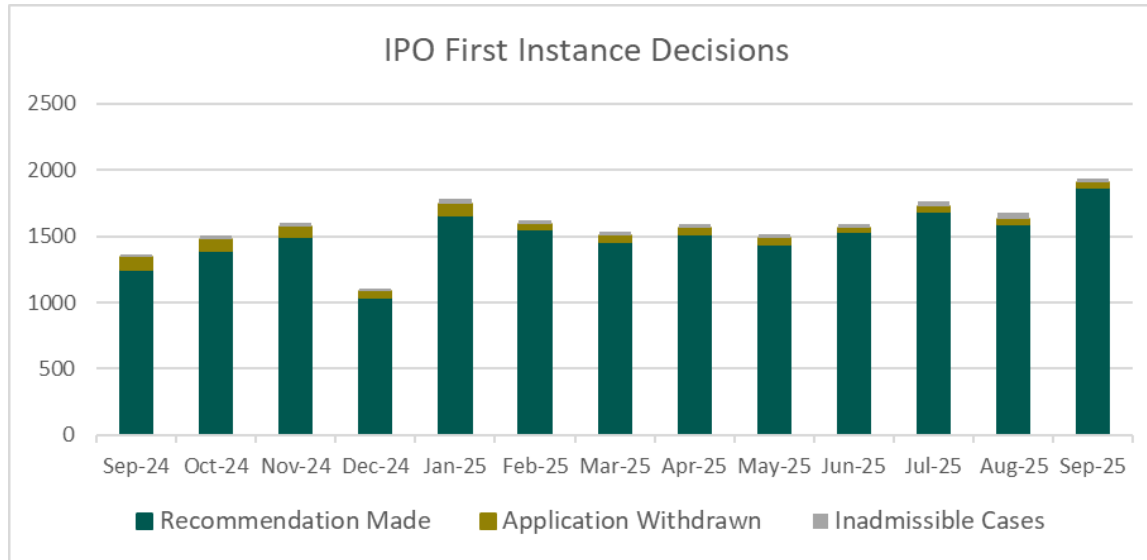
- In September 2025 there were 1,330 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,559 last September
- The total number of applications in September 2025 that fell under accelerated procedure was 589 (which represents 44% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (1,401 applications), Somalia (1,315), Pakistan (1,230), Afghanistan (967) and Georgia (690)

Pending International Protection Applications

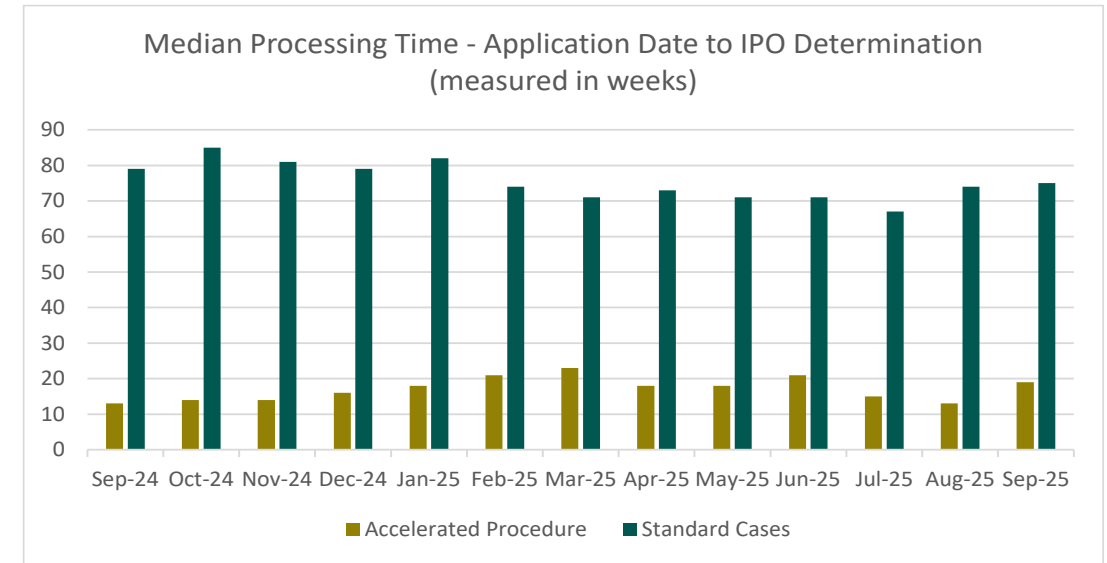


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 17,021. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In September 2025, there were 16,067 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of September 2025 is 152

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

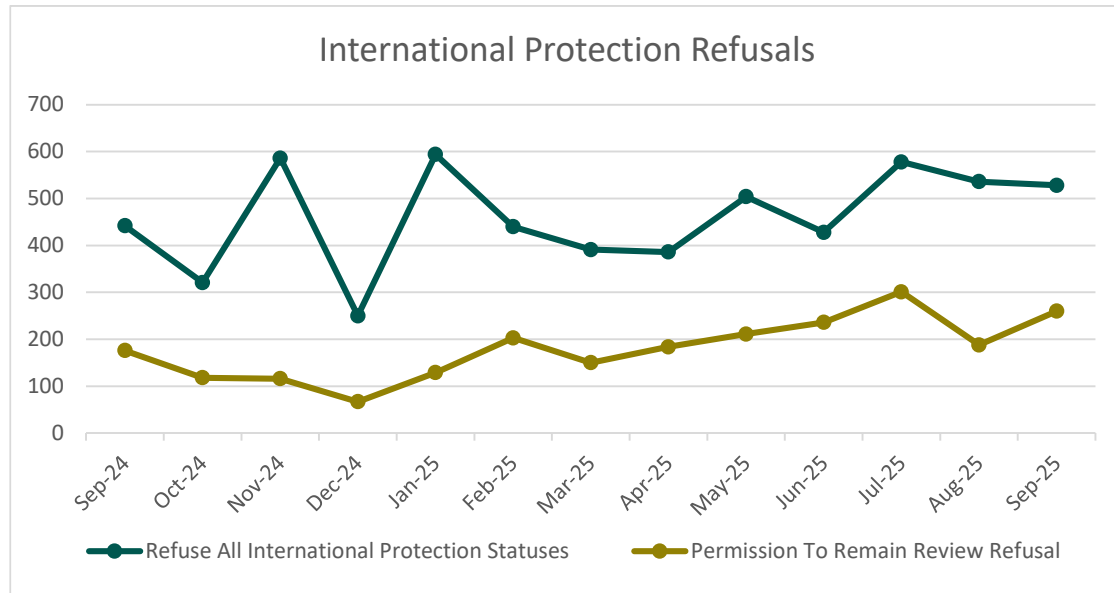
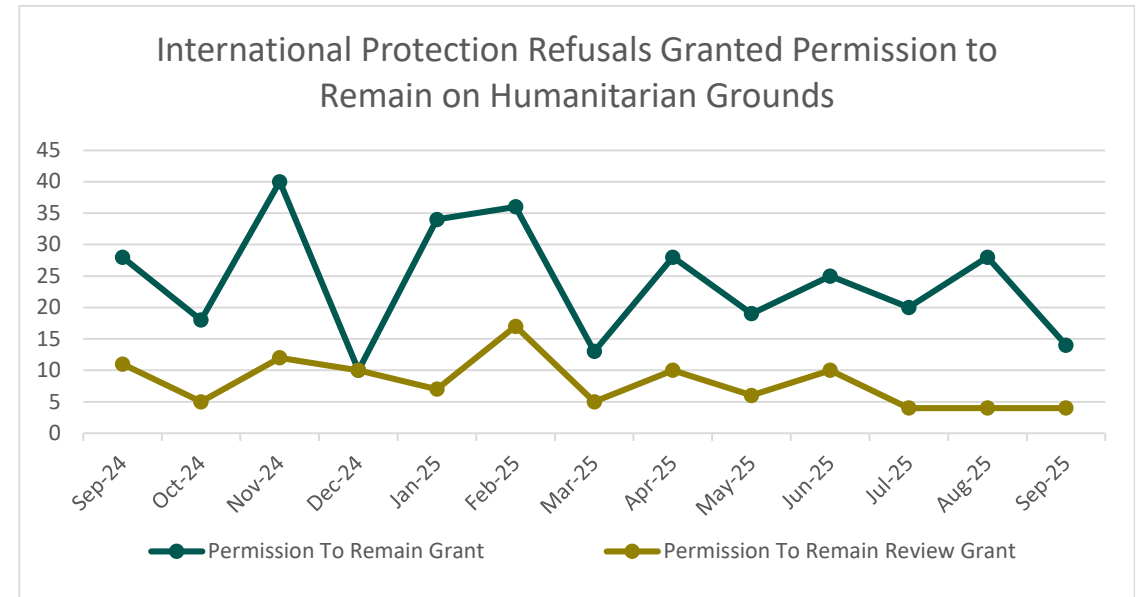
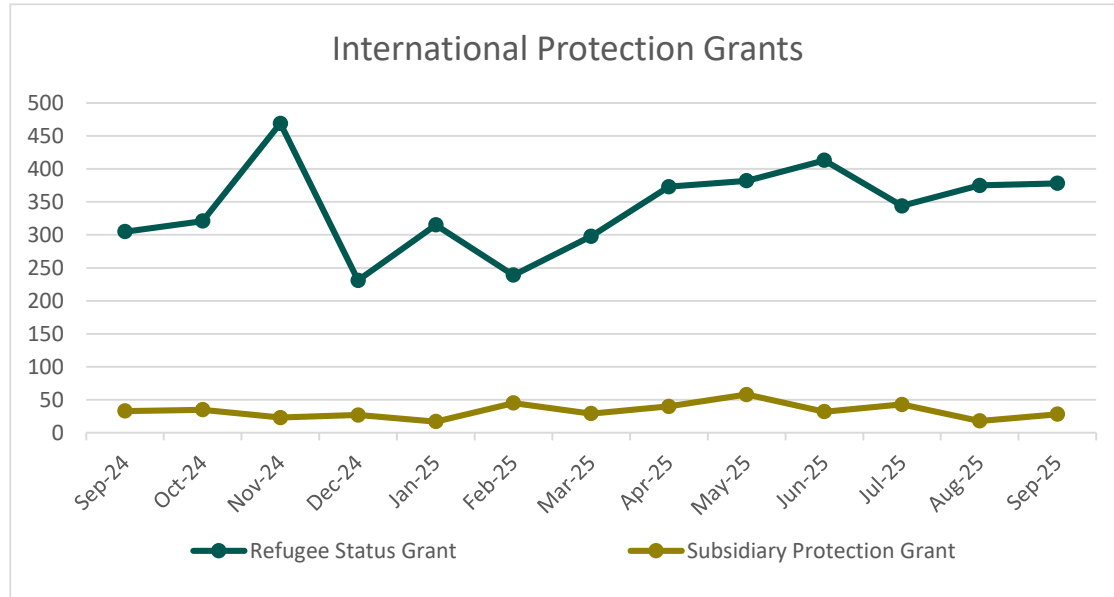


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In September 2025, 1,936 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,764 in July and up from 1,675 in August.
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 15,017 (a 51.7% increase on 9,901 applications processed for 2024 YTD)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been increasing in the last two months for Standard Cases. There has been some fluctuation in the median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure, with the latest figures showing an increase in September 2025
- In September 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 75 weeks (up from 67 weeks in July and 74 weeks in August)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 19 weeks in September 2025, up from 15 weeks in July and 13 weeks in August

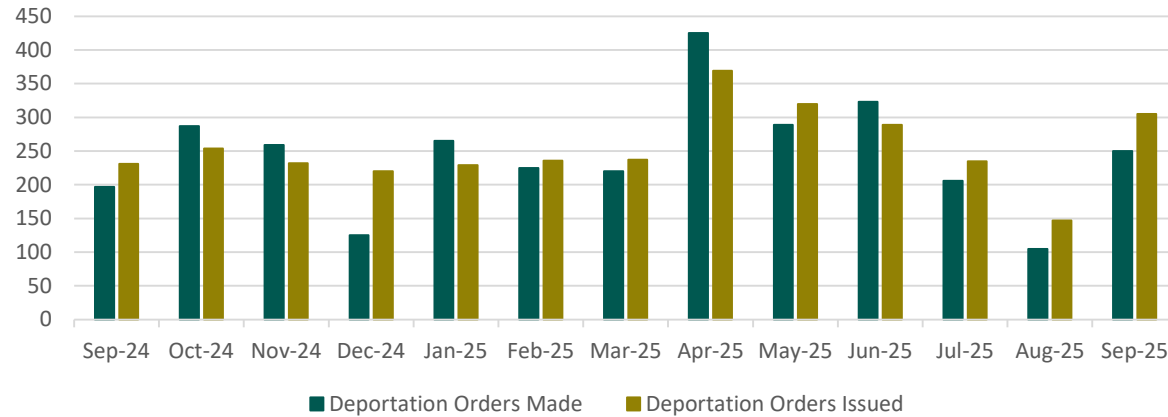
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In September 2025, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 378 were given refugee status grant and 28 subsidiary protection grant (406 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 14 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 4 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 528 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 260 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for September 2025, 54% of decisions were refusals, 2% permission to remain, and 44% were international protection grants

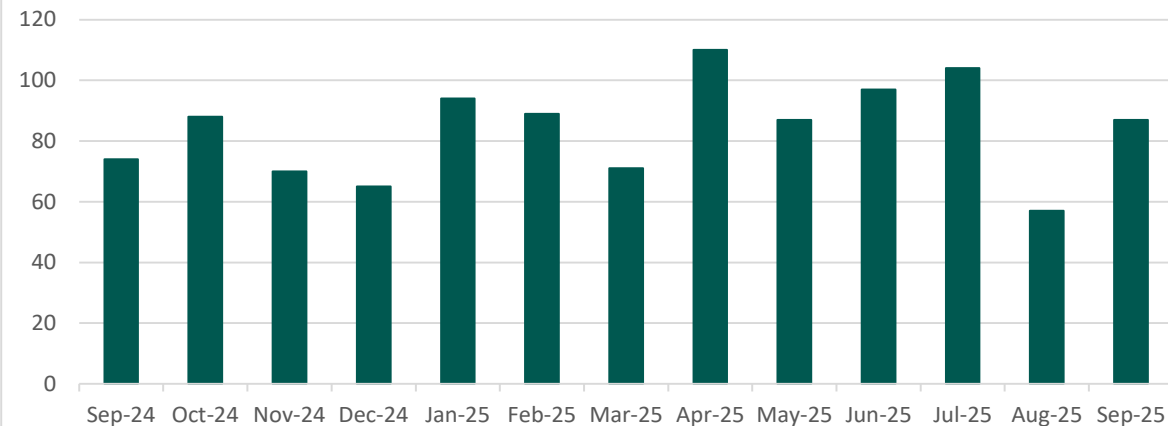
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

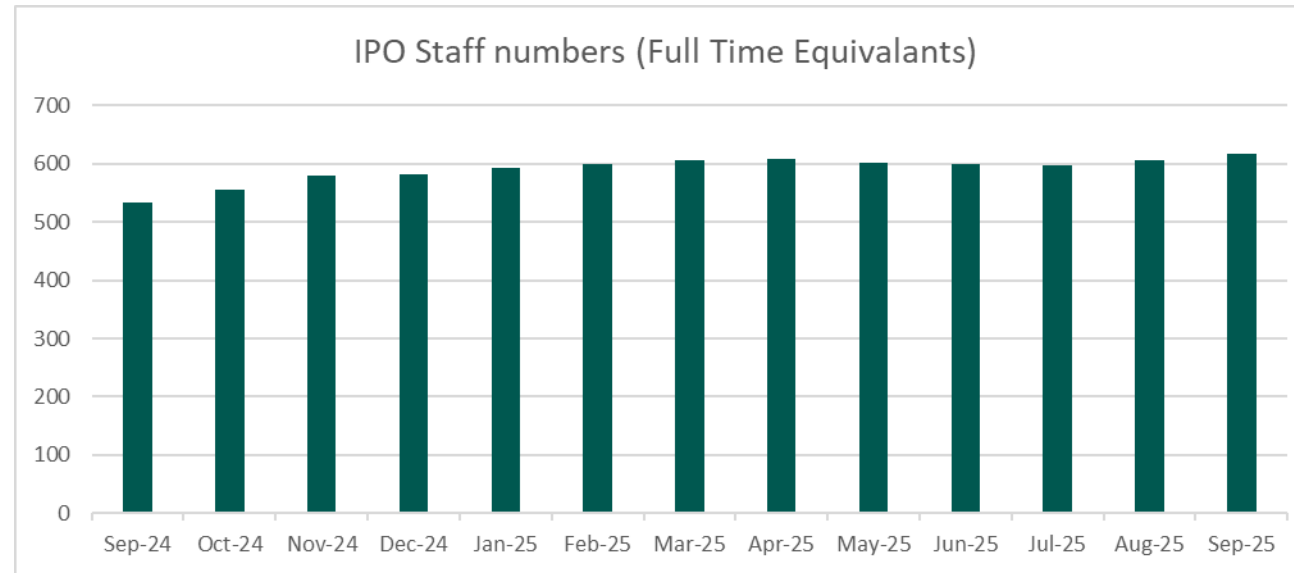


- For September 2025 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 250 and the number of deportation orders issued was 305. For August, the figures were 105 and 147, and for July, the figures were 206 and 235, respectively
- For September 2025 the number of removals was 87

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In September 2024 there were 534 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 607 in March 2025 and 600 in June 2025
- At the end of September 2025, the IPO had 618 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

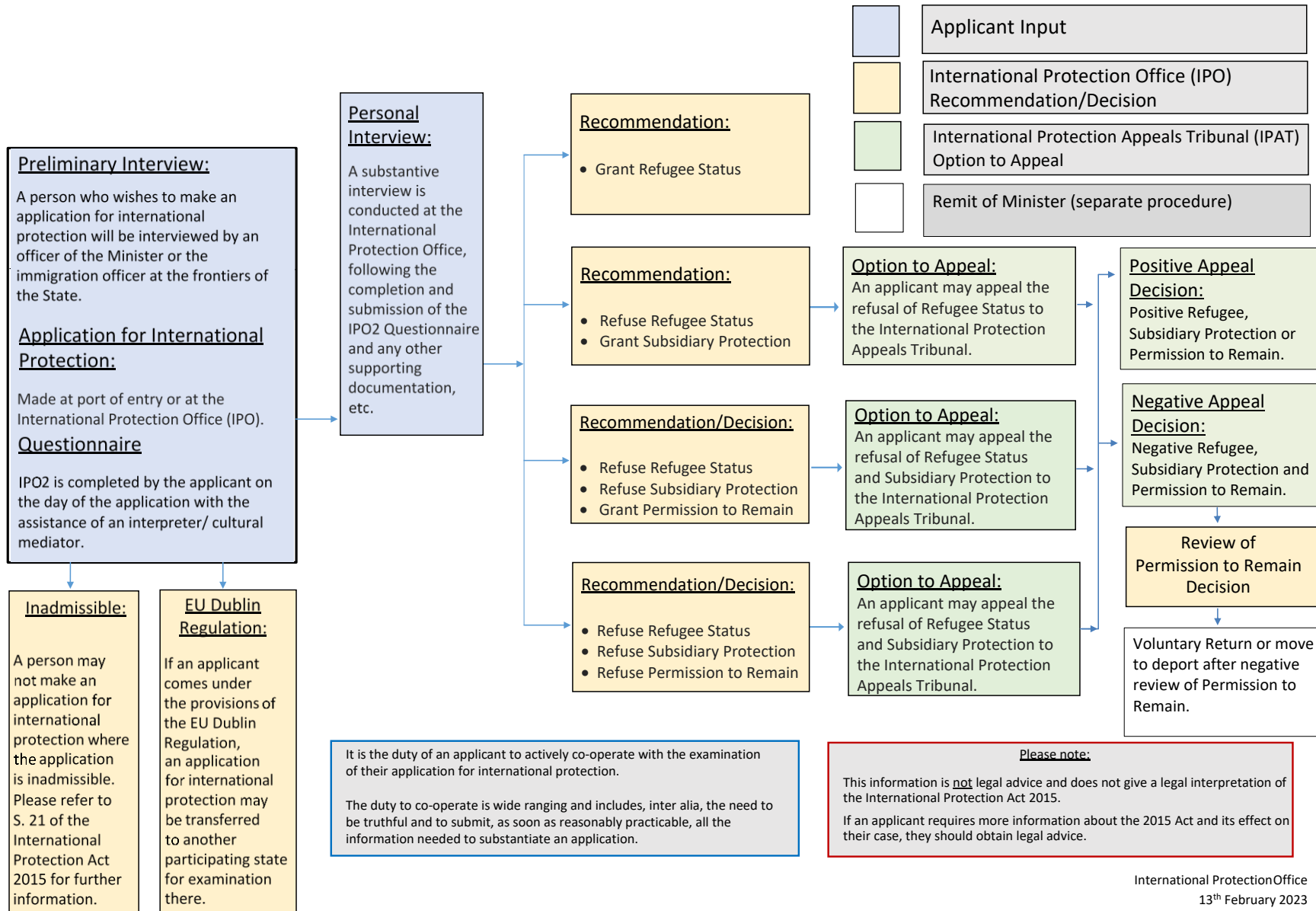
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
Accelerated Procedure	924	453	282	377	351	347	263	327	333	285	344	440	589
Standard Cases	635	599	613	647	734	742	586	748	610	717	821	611	741

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	1401	14.6%
Somalia	1315	13.7%
Pakistan	1230	12.8%
Afghanistan	967	10.1%
Georgia	690	7.2%
Other	3986	41.6%
Total	9589	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
IP Pending	23,863	23,373	22,641	22,548	21,882	21,343	20,655	20,122	19,551	18,922	18,323	17,676	17,021
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
IPAT Pending	7331	7989	8512	9241	10123	11028	11814	12517	13393	14035	14529	15397	16067

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
MDU Pending	100	162	176	141	191	186	216	168	123	95	119	101	152

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
Recommendation Made	1244	1393	1491	1039	1657	1551	1459	1515	1442	1531	1684	1589	1868
Application Withdrawn	101	83	80	43	84	38	47	43	41	31	40	40	40
Inadmissible Cases	19	29	26	21	40	35	31	34	34	29	40	46	28

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
Accelerated Procedure	13	14	14	16	18	21	23	18	18	21	15	13	19
Standard Cases	79	85	81	79	82	74	71	73	71	71	67	74	75

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
Refugee Status Grant	305	321	469	231	315	239	298	373	382	413	344	375	378
Subsidiary Protection Grant	33	35	23	27	17	45	29	40	58	32	43	18	28
Permission To Remain Grant	28	18	40	10	34	36	13	28	19	25	20	28	14
Permission To Remain Review Grant	11	5	12	10	7	17	5	10	6	10	4	4	4

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	442	321	586	250	594	440	391	386	504	428	578	536	528
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	176	118	116	67	129	203	150	184	211	236	301	188	260

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
Deportation Orders Made	197	287	259	125	265	225	220	425	289	323	206	105	250
Deportation Orders Issued	231	254	232	220	229	236	237	369	320	289	235	147	305

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
Enforcements/Returns*	74	88	70	65	94	89	71	110	87	97	104	57	87

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25
IPO Staffing Levels	534.3	556.3	579.1	582.1	593.4	598.8	607	608	601	600	598	606	618.2